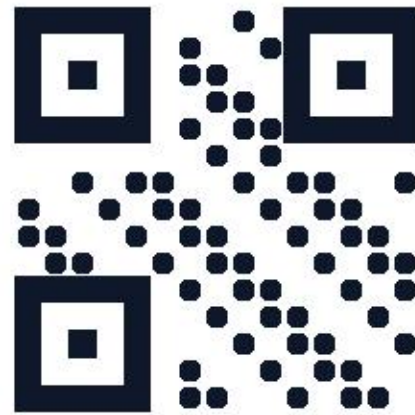


QR codes were not born in marketing.

They started as a practical answer to a factory problem. Which explains a lot about why they still work.



not a gimmick origin story

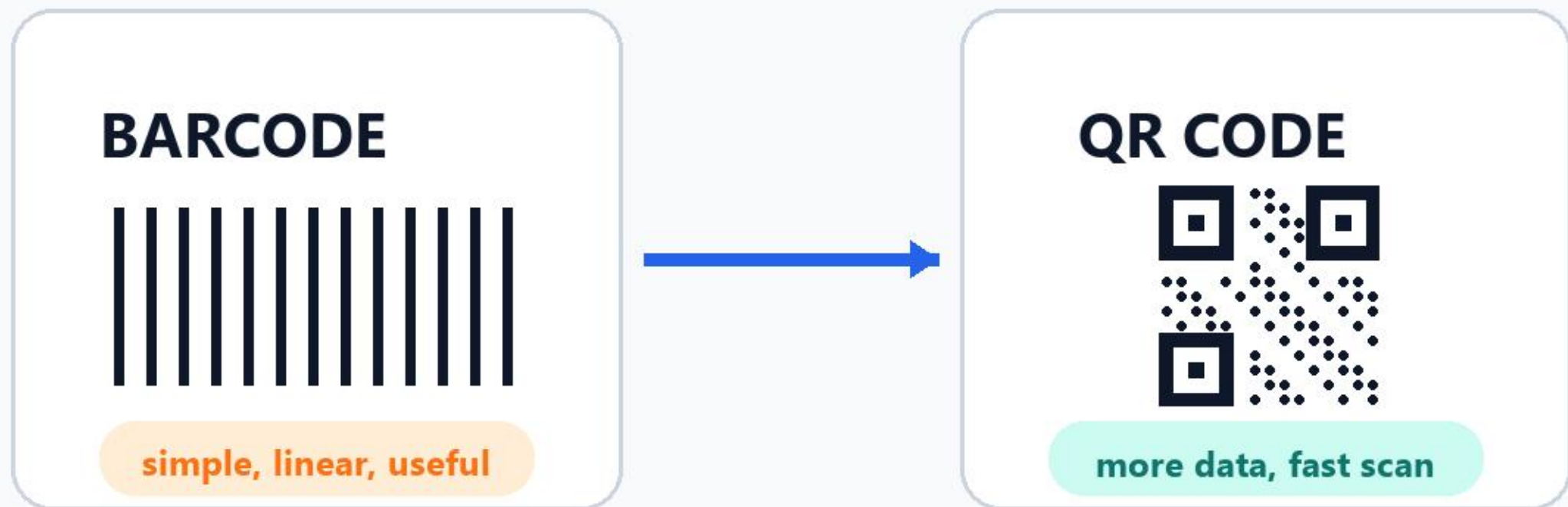
Factories had a boring, expensive information problem.

Parts moved fast. Labels needed to be scanned quickly. Old barcode workflows were useful, but limited.

The job was not to look clever. The job was to move information reliably.



Barcodes were good. The new job needed more.



The QR code design brief was quietly ambitious.



scan quickly from many angles



store more information



survive dirt and damage



work on real-world surfaces

QR literally means Quick Response.

Not ?mysterious square.? Not ?marketing pixel thing.? Just a very literal name for what the format was meant to do.

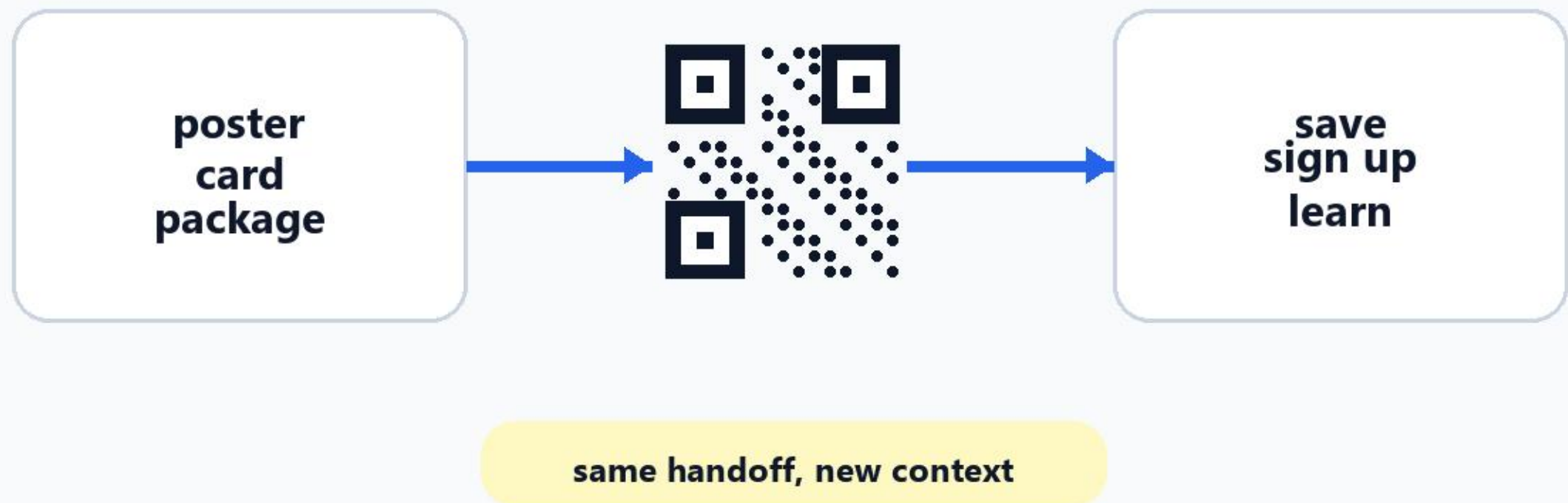


**A machine-readable
shortcut
from object to
information.**

literal naming: underrated

Marketing adopted QR codes for the same reason factories did.

They connect something physical to useful digital information.



Then marketers made the classic mistake.

They treated the QR code as the campaign, instead of the doorway.

no reason to scan

slow page

unclear next step

Good QR marketing is boringly specific.



clear reason to scan



mobile-friendly destination

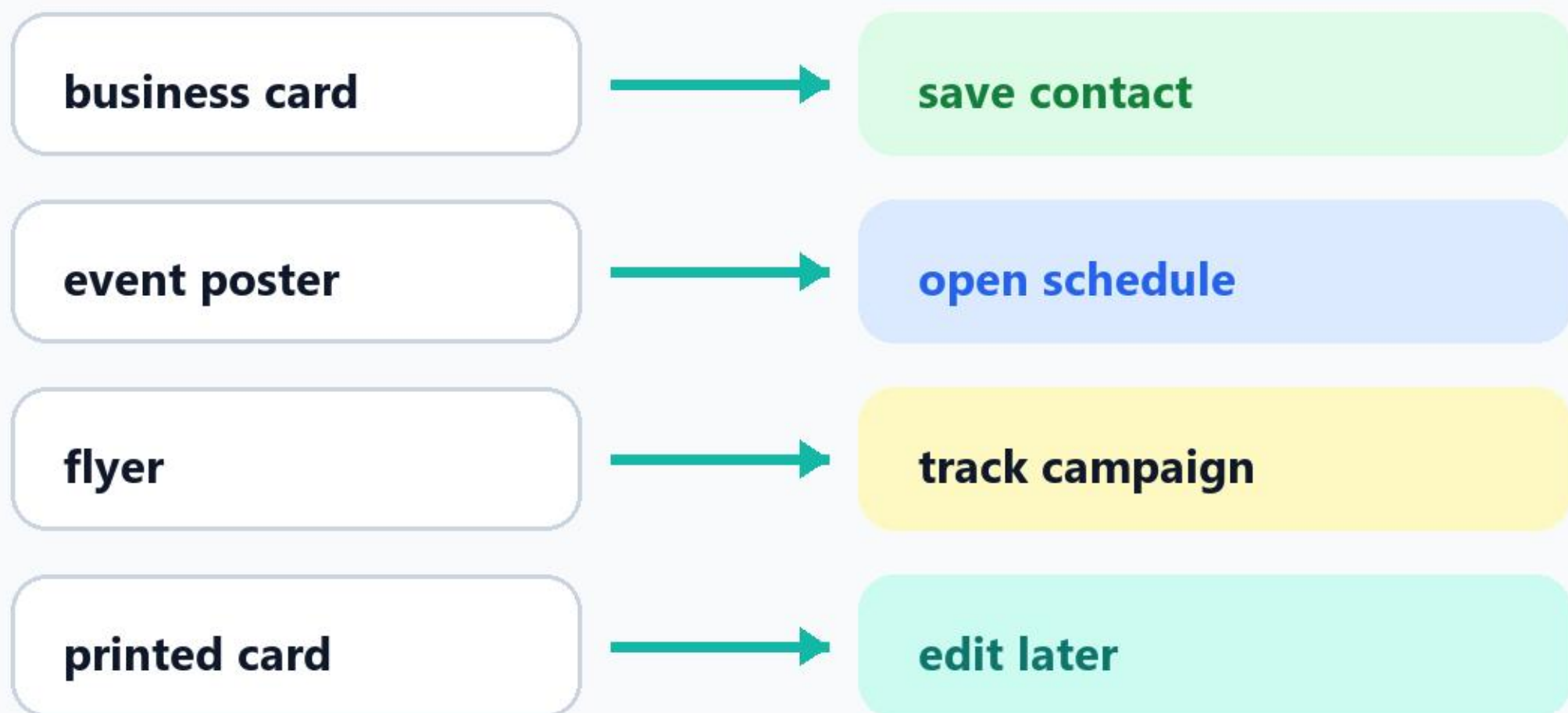


one next action

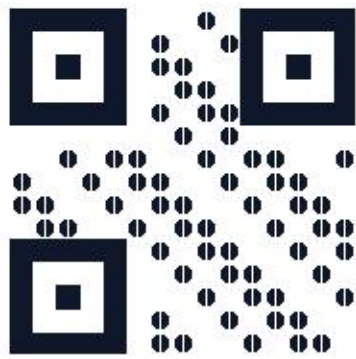


measurable result

The best QR use cases are usually boring in the right way.



QR codes work best when they do one useful job.



**Not magic.
Not a whole campaign.
Just a fast handoff from
physical interest to a clear next
step.**

**Look at one printed asset.
Does it have a real next step?**